

filter() , map() , and reduce() in Python

Functional Programming in Python

Python supports a **functional programming style**, where **functions can be passed as arguments** to other functions.

The three most commonly used higher-order functions are:

- `filter()`
- `map()`
- `reduce()`

filter() Function

Purpose:

Filters elements of a sequence based on a condition (returns only those elements that satisfy the condition).

`filter(function, iterable)`

- **function:** A function that returns **True** or **False**
- **iterable:** A sequence (like list, tuple, etc.)

Returns an iterator – wrap it in `list()` to get final results.

Example:

```
nums = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
even_nums = list(filter(lambda x: x % 2 == 0, nums))
print(even_nums)    # Output: [2, 4, 6]
```

Explanation:

- The lambda function checks for even numbers.
- `filter()` keeps only values for which function returns **True**.

Without Lambda (using def):

```
def is_even(n):
    return n % 2 == 0

even_nums = list(filter(is_even, nums))
```

map () Function

Purpose:

Applies a function to **each item** in an iterable and returns a new sequence.

Syntax:

```
map(function, iterable)
```

Returns an iterator – use `list ( )` to see the result.

Example:

```
nums = [1, 2, 3, 4]
Data = list(map(lambda x: x+1, nums))
print(Data)    # Output: [2,3,4,5]
```

Explanation:

- The lambda returns `x` increased by 1
- `map ( )` applies it to every element of `nums`

Without Lambda:

```
def increase(x):
    return x + 1
```

```
Data = list(map(increase, nums))
```

reduce () Function

Purpose:

Applies a function cumulatively to reduce the iterable to a **single value**.

Syntax:

```
from functools import reduce
```

```
reduce(function, iterable)
```

- The function takes **two arguments**
- Applies cumulatively: `f ( f ( f (x1, x2), x3), x4) ...`

Example:

```
from functools import reduce

nums = [1, 2, 3, 4]
Sum = reduce(lambda x, y: x + y, nums)
print(Sum)    # Output: 10
```

Explanation:

- $(1+2) = 3, (2+3) = 5, (6+4) = 10$

Without Lambda:

```
def Add(x, y):
    return x + y
```

```
product = reduce(Add, nums)
```

Comparison Table:

Function	Purpose	Returns	Requires Import
<code>filter()</code>	Filters items based on condition	Filtered items	No
<code>map()</code>	Applies a function to each item	Transformed list	No
<code>reduce()</code>	Reduces to a single value	Single result	Yes (functools)